

Table 10.5 Size Statistics

Description	Up Breakout	Down Breakout
Tall pattern performance	46%	−18%
Short pattern performance	39%	−13%
Median height as a percentage of breakout price	9.7%	10.4%
Narrow pattern performance	41%	−15%
Wide pattern performance	45%	−16%
Median width	50 days	42 days
Short and narrow performance	40%	−13%
Short and wide performance	37%	−10%
Tall and wide performance	48%	−18%
Tall and narrow performance	43%	−18%

Width. Wide patterns outperform narrow ones but not by an amount worth telling Mom about. I used the median length to separate narrow patterns from wide ones.

Height and width combinations. The worst performance comes from patterns that are both short and wide. You will want to avoid those. The best performance happens for patterns both tall and wide. The performance differences are large enough that you should pay attention to them when contemplating a trade.

Table 10.6 shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend. Volume trends upward most often, but the direction is near random.

Rising/Falling volume. Broadening patterns with rising volume trend show better performance after the breakout than when volume recedes (as measured from the start to the end of the pattern).

Breakout volume. Technical analysts seem to place a lot of emphasis on heavy breakout volume, but as the table shows, the results I found are not